Giuditta Perinelli

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MIT Sloan, Department of Finance

Education

Ph.D. in Finance, MIT Sloan, 2021–2027 (expected)
M.Sc. in Economics and Social Science, Bocconi University (Double Degree), 2015–2018
M.Sc. in Economics, Keio University (Double Degree), 2016–2017
B.Sc. in Economics and Finance, Bocconi University, 2012–2015

Fields

Corporate Finance, Macro-finance

References

David Thesmar, MIT Sloan — thesmar@mit.edu
Emil Verner, MIT Sloan — everner@mit.edu
Jonathan Parker, MIT Sloan — jparker@mit.edu
Tong Liu, MIT Sloan — tongl@mit.edu

Teaching Experience

Finance Lab (MFin, MBA), TA to Gita Rao, MIT Sloan, 2026
Advanced Analytics of Finance (MFin, MBA), TA to Hui Chen, MIT Sloan, 2025
Analytics of Finance (MFin, MBA), TA to Hui Chen, MIT Sloan, 2025
Futures and Options Pricing (MFin, MBA), TA to Debbie Lucas, MIT Sloan, 2024
Advanced Asset Pricing (PhD), TA to Hui Chen, Leonid Kogan, Debbie Lucas, Jonathan Parker, Adrien Verdelhan, MIT Sloan, 2023–2024
Advanced Corporate Finance (MFin, MBA), TA to Egor Matveyev, MIT Sloan, 2023–2024

Work Experience

Research Assistant to David Thesmar and Luigi Zingales, MIT Sloan, 2022
Predoctoral Fellowship with Olivier Darmouni, Columbia Business School, 2019–2021
Traineeship with Marie Hoerova, ECB Research Division, 2018–2019

Summer Schools

Wharton Structural Summer School, 2025
Yale Summer School in Behavioral Finance, 2024 (Read my interview here!)
NBER Behavioral Macroeconomics Boot Camp, 2024
Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money and Finance, 2023
Big-Data Initiative in International Macro-Finance, Stanford GSB, 2023

Job Market Paper

Temporary Liquidity and Firm Investment: the Large Effects from Corporate Debt Moratoria in a Time of Crisis
with Alberto Grassi and Nils Kerwien
Presentation: 2025 Annual Carey Finance Conference

We study how firms respond to temporary liquidity relief and which policies can support investment cost-effectively during crises. We exploit a large-

scale debt moratorium introduced in Austria in 2020, which allowed firms to temporarily suspend loan repayments. Exploiting size-based eligibility in a difference-in-differences design, we estimate a marginal propensity to invest of 76 cents per euro of postponed loan repayments among moratorium takers. The moratorium increases investment and profitability without raising defaults once repayments resume, yet a take-up rate of only 44% suggests an important role for selection. We rationalize these findings in a dynamic investment model and compare moratoria with grants, which provide liquidity that firms do not need to repay. Unlike grants, moratoria induce virtuous self-selection by firms with profitable investment opportunities. In the model, moratoria generate investment responses comparable to those of grants, but at a substantially lower fiscal cost. Our findings suggest that moratoria offer fiscally constrained governments a cost-effective tool to stimulate investment during crises.

Working Papers

Investors and Inflation
with M. Hoerova and J. Breckenfelder
Presentation: 2025 ESADE Spring Workshop, EEA 2025, CEPR Annual MEF Symposium 2025.

We study how the source of inflation and the investor base jointly shape portfolio rebalancing. We distinguish between cost-push ("bad") inflation and demand-driven ("good") inflation. Using expectations from the Survey of Professional Forecasters as a proxy for sophisticated investors' beliefs, we show that bad inflation shocks induce stagflationary expectations, whereas good inflation shocks raise expected inflation and improve expected economic activity. Remarkably, household expectations move in a similar way. Using security-level holdings of bond and equity mutual fund shares, we show that portfolio rebalancing is broadly consistent with these shifts in expectations: bad inflation generates outflows from both bond and equity funds, whereas good inflation generates outflows from bond funds and inflows into equity funds. Our identification strategy compares flows across fund shares held by different investor types within the same fund, holding the underlying portfolio risk fixed. We show that the investor base determines how rebalancing unfolds: investment funds rebalance rapidly and strongly, households adjust more gradually but persistently, and insurance companies rebalance more selectively. Within bond funds, portfolios with higher residual maturity-our proxy for duration exposure-experience larger return losses following both types of inflation shocks. Residual maturity matters particularly for institutional investors: following good inflation, flows by investment funds and insurance companies are consistent with a shift from higher-to lower-maturity funds, whereas household flows vary less with maturity. Following bad inflation, investors redeem from both maturity segments. The source of inflation therefore determines the direction of portfolio rebalancing while investor composition and duration exposure determine its speed, persistence, and distribution across asset classes and maturities.

Specialized Lending with Limited Pledgeability
with B. Dubois and P. Rintamäki

We develop a model of credit cycles in which specialized lenders can preserve borrower going-concern value after foreclosure, allowing firms to borrow against value that arm's-length financiers cannot fully realize. Limited pledgeability arises because this recovery advantage cannot be fully transferred to the intermediary's own creditors, so specialized lending requires intermediary balance-sheet resources. With heterogeneous borrowers, specialized intermediaries expand credit especially to firms with less transferable, more intangible value. Following sufficiently large adverse shocks, however, scarce intermediary resources induce a *flight-to-pledgeability*, shifting new lending toward borrowers with higher recovery values. We then apply the model to the private credit market and show that the presence of specialized intermediaries can explain several facts about lending cycles and private credit specialization. We also test and find supportive evidence for flight-to-pledgeability, using Business Development Company lending during COVID-19 as our laboratory.

Inflation Expectations, Investment, and the Mundell-Tobin Financing Channel
with J. Mejia and A. Tagliabracci
Presentation: Dauphine Finance PhD Workshop.

We provide causal evidence that firms' investment responsiveness to inflation depends strongly on the horizon over which inflation is expected. Exploiting a randomized information treatment embedded in the Bank of Italy's Survey of Inflation and Growth Expectations, we construct a sign-adjusted instrument for exogenous shocks to expected inflation at horizons of six months, one year, two years, and three–five years. We show that total investment is increasing in the forecast horizon, but the effect is larger for tangible than intangible investment. We interpret these findings through the lens of a classic Mundell-Tobin channel. Higher inflation expectations reduce the real cost of externally financed tangible capital and stimulate investment. Intangible investment, which is primarily internally financed, rises only through its complementarity with tangibles. Our heterogeneity analyses by expectation horizon, liquidity, and leverage help rule out alternative channels, reinforcing our interpretation.

Academic Service
Sloan Finance PhD Student "Above and Beyond" Prize, 2024
Organizer, Finance Student Seminars, MIT Sloan, 2022–2024

Software Skills
R, Stata, Matlab, Python